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HARVARD UNIVERSITY

EDUCATION

Harvard University
Ph.D. Health Policy (Political Analysis), May 2027 (expected)

University of Pittsburgh
B.S., Neuroscience, *cum laude*, May 2017

FIELDS

Research: Political analysis; Medicaid; Medicare; dual-eligibles; quasi-experimental methods; administrative data; pharmaco-economics; survey analysis; LGBT health

Teaching: Political analysis; Administrative data for health research; Introduction to health policy; Safety net policies; LGBT health

DISSERTATION PAPERS

- The Impact of Medicaid Coverage of Gender-affirming Care on Surgery and Hormone Use and Adverse Mental Health Outcomes
- The Impact of Pharmacy Closures on Prescription Drug and Acute Care Use among Medicaid Enrollees with Serious Mental Illness
- Differences in Mail-order Pharmacy Utilization between Medicaid and Medicare Enrollees, 2016-2021

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. Fung V, Cheng D, Price M, Khong K, Yang Z, Marcondes FO, **Koma JW**, Hsu J, Alegría M, Newhouse JP. (2026) State Expansions in Medicaid Financial Assistance for Low-Income Medicare Beneficiaries: Changes in Enrollment and Use. *Health Services Research*. 61(3): e70116.
2. Yang Z, Cheng D, Price M, Khong K, Duong T, **Koma JW**, Hsu J, Alegría M, Newhouse JP, Fung V. (2026) Medicaid Retention After Transition to Medicare Among Adults With Expansion Coverage. *JAMA Network Open*. 9(4): e268560.
3. **Koma JW**, Khong K, Freitas Dias A, Babbs G, Rosenthal M, Charlton B, Huskamp H, McDowell A, Fung V. (2026) Unmet mental health need and barriers to care among transgender and cisgender adults. *American Journal of Preventive Medicine*. 70(5): 108246.
4. **Koma JW**, Yang Z, Price M, Cheng D, Marcondes F, Khong K, Hsu J, Alegría M, Newhouse JP, Fung V. (2025) Qualified Medicare Beneficiary Program: Enrollment Trends and Characteristics of Low-Income Beneficiaries. *Health Affairs*. 44(7): 878-886.
   - Media coverage: interview with Health Affairs' Podcast
5. Bleich SN, **Koma JW**, Jernigan VBB. (2023) The Worsening Problem of Food Insecurity. *JAMA Health Forum*. 4(11): e234974.
6. Agénor M, **Koma JW**, Pérez AE, McDowell A, Gonzales G. (2023) Differences in Health Insurance and Usual Source of Care Among Racial/Ethnic and Sexual Orientation Subgroups of U.S. Women and Men. *Population Research and Policy Review*. 42: 33.

7. **Koma JW**, Fugelsten Biniek J, Cubanski J, Neuman T. (2023) Access Problems and Cost Concerns of Younger Medicare Beneficiaries Exceeded those of Older Beneficiaries in 2019. *Health Affairs*. 42(4): 470-478.
8. **Koma JW**, Vercammen KA, Jarlenski MP, Frelier JM, Bleich SN. (2020) Sugary Drink Consumption among Children by Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program Status. *American Journal of Preventive Medicine*. 58(1): 69-78.
9. Agénor M, Pérez AE, **Koma JW**, Abrams JA, McGregor AJ, Ojikutu BO. (2019) Sexual Orientation Identity, Race/Ethnicity, and Lifetime HIV Testing in a National Probability Sample of U.S. Women and Men: An Intersectional Approach. *LGBT Health*. 6(6): 306-318.
10. Vercammen KA, **Koma JW**, Bleich SN. (2019) Trends in Energy Drink Consumption Among U.S. Adolescents and Adults, 2003-2016. *American Journal of Preventive Medicine*. 56(6): 827-833.
    - Media coverage: US News
11. Jarlenski M, **Koma JW**, Zank J, Bodnar L, Tarr JA, Chang JC. (2018) Media Portrayal of Prenatal and Postpartum Marijuana Use in an Era of Scientific Uncertainty. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence*. 187: 116-122.
    - Media coverage: Kaiser Health News (KHN), ABC News, Salon
12. Bleich SN, Vercammen KA, **Koma JW**, Li Z. (2018) Trends in Beverage Consumption Among Children and Adults, 2003-2014. *Obesity*. 26(2): 432-441.
    - Selected as "Best of Obesity 2019"
    - Selected as "Top Cited Obesity Article 2018-2019"
13. **Koma JW**, Donohue JM, Barry CL, Huskamp HA, Jarlenski M. (2017) Medicaid Coverage Expansions and Cigarette Smoking Cessation Among Low-income Adults. *Medical Care*. 55(12): 1023-1029.
    - Media coverage: Vox, Pittsburgh Tribune Review, US News
14. Jarlenski M, **Koma JW**, Zank J, Bodnar LM, Bogen DL, Chang JC. (2017) Trends in Perception of Risk of Regular Marijuana Use among US Pregnant and Nonpregnant Reproductive-aged Women. *American Journal of Obstetrics & Gynecology*. 217(6): 705-707.

RESEARCH GRANTS

Medicaid Before Medicare: Effects on Coverage, Access, and Use

- **Role**: Project Director (PI: Vicki Fung)
- **Dates**: 2026-2028
- **Funder**: Commonwealth Fund
- **Description**: The goal of this project is to assess how pre-Medicare Medicaid coverage shapes low-income adults' insurance outcomes, healthcare access, and utilization following Medicare entry, using linked Health and Retirement Study and claims data.

National Research Service Award (NRSA) T32 Predoctoral Fellowship (T32MH019733)

FELLOWSHIPS

Graduate Society Summer Predissertation Fellowship
Harvard Kenneth C. Griffin Graduate School of Arts and Sciences, 2024
Chancellor's Undergraduate Research Fellowship
University of Pittsburgh Honors College, 2017

Berner International Corporation Private Research Grant
University of Pittsburgh Honors College, 2016
Brackenridge Undergraduate Research Fellowship
University of Pittsburgh Honors College, 2016
Community-Based Undergraduate Research Fellowship
University of Pittsburgh Honors College, 2015
Fostering Advancement & Careers Through Enrichment Training in Science (FACETS) Fellowship
Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health, 2015-2017

HONORS AND AWARDS

LGBTQ Health Center of Excellence Conference Award
Harvard University, 2025
National Science Foundation GRFP Honorable Mention
Harvard University, 2024
AcademyHealth Conference Funding
NORC at the University of Chicago, 2018
University Honors College Scholar Designation
University of Pittsburgh, 2017

TEACHING

Research in Global Health and Health Policy, 2025

- Institution: Harvard College
- Role: Teaching Fellow (Faculty: Professor David Cutler)
- Class size and content: 13 Undergraduate students; Taught the principles of policy-writing and analysis through a 50-page policy proposal developed over the semester with each student

The Changing Landscape of Hospitals in America, 2024

- Institution: Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health
- Role: Teaching Fellow (Faculty: Professor Alecia McGregor)
- Class size and content: 33 public health graduate students; Principles and history of hospital care payment and reform, with particular focus on mergers and acquisitions and hospital ownership structures

The Health Care Safety Net & Marginalized Populations, 2023

- Institution: Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health
- Role: Teaching Fellow (Faculty: Professor Ben Sommers)
- Class size and content: 30 public health graduate students; History and analysis of health care safety net and reform in U.S.

Introduction to Health Policy, 2022

- Institution: Massachusetts Institute of Technology
- Role: Teaching Assistant (Faculty: Professor Andrea Campbell)
- Class size and content: 35 undergraduate students; Introduction to health policy with a focus on payers, providers, and enrollees and their health outcomes through a political science and health economics focus

WORK EXPERIENCE

Harvard University Dept. of Health Care Policy
Research Assistant, 2022 – Present

Massachusetts General Hospital – Mongan Institute for Health Policy
Research Assistant, 2022 – Present

KFF (Kaiser Family Foundation) – Program on Medicare Policy
Policy Analyst, 2020 – 2022

KFF (Kaiser Family Foundation) – Program on Medicare Policy
Research Assistant, 2018 – 2020

NORC at the University of Chicago – Dept. of Health Care Evaluation
Research Assistant, 2017

University of Pittsburgh Graduate School of Public Health – Dept. of Health Policy and Management
Undergraduate Research Assistant, 2015 – 2017

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (PEER-REVIEWED)

Oral Presentations:

1. **Koma JW**, Liu P, Ranganathan K, Landrum MB, Fung V, McDowell A. The Impact of Medicaid Coverage of Gender-affirming Care on Surgery and Hormone Use and Adverse Mental Health Outcomes. American Society for Health Economics. 2026.
2. **Koma JW**, Kakani P, Maestas N. Impact of Pharmacy Closures on Medicaid Enrollees with Serious Mental Illness (SMI). American Society for Health Economics. 2026.
3. **Koma JW**, McElroy J, Liu P, Ranganathan K, Landrum MB, Fung V, McDowell A. Effect of Medicaid Coverage Changes on Transgender Enrollees' Mental Health. American Society for Health Economics. 2025.
4. **Koma JW**, McElroy J, Liu P, Ranganathan K, Landrum MB, Fung V, McDowell A. Effect of Medicaid Coverage Changes on Transgender Enrollees' Mental Health. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. 2025.
5. **Koma JW**, Freitas Dias A, Babbs G, Rosenthal M, Fung V, McDowell A. Rates of insurance coverage of gender-affirming care and utilization among transgender adults by insurance type in 2022. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. 2024.

Poster Presentations:

6. **Koma JW**, Kakani P, Maestas N. The Impact of Pharmacy Closures on Medication Access among Medicaid Enrollees with Serious Mental Illness. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. 2026
7. **Koma JW**, Liu P, Ranganathan K, Landrum MB, Fung V, McDowell A. The Impact of Medicaid Coverage of Gender-affirming Care on Surgery Use & Adverse Mental Health Outcomes. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. 2026
8. **Koma JW**, Yang Z, Cheng D, Patel T, Marcondes F, Price M, Alegría M, Hsu J, Newhouse JP, Fung V. Enrollment in the Qualified Medicare Beneficiary Program and Access to Care for Low-income Medicare Beneficiaries. Society for General Internal Medicine. 2024.
9. **Koma JW**, Yang Z, Cheng D, Patel T, Marcondes F, Price M, Alegría M, Hsu J, Newhouse JP, Fung V. Enrollment in the Qualified Medicare Beneficiary Program and Access to Care for Low-income Medicare Beneficiaries. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. 2024.
10. **Koma JW**, Jarlenski M, Vercammen KA, Bleich SN. Trends in sugar-sweetened beverage consumption among children in the United States by Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program eligibility status. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. 2018.

11. **Koma JW**, Agénor M. Sexual orientation disparities in HIV testing among white, black, Latina/o, Asian, and Native young adult U.S. women and men. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. 2018.
12. **Koma JW**, Donohue J, Barry CL, Huskamp HA, Jarlenski MP. Cigarette smoking cessation among low-income adults without dependent children after Medicaid expansion. Academy Health Annual Research Meeting. 2017.
13. **Koma JW**, Donohue J, Barry CL, Huskamp HA, Jarlenski MP. Cigarette smoking cessation among low-income adults without dependent children after Medicaid expansion. ACC Meeting of the Minds. 2016.
14. **Koma JW**, Jarlenski M, Rosenthal M. Trends in insurance and access to health care among low-income adults before and after the ACA Medicaid expansion. *Science Conference*. 2015.

INVITED LECTURES

1. Speaker: How does Medicaid Coverage of Gender-affirming Care Impact Utilization and Adverse Mental Health Outcomes among Medicaid Enrollees? American Economic Association Committee on the Status of LGBTQ+ Individuals in the Economics Profession (CSQIEP) Virtual Seminar Series, October 2026.
2. Speaker: How does Medicaid Coverage of Gender-affirming Care Impact Utilization and Adverse Mental Health Outcomes among Medicaid Enrollees? Harvard Kennedy School's Global LGBTQI+ Human Rights Research Convening, April 2026.
3. Speaker: How does Medicaid Coverage of Gender-affirming Care Impact Utilization and Adverse Mental Health Outcomes among Medicaid Enrollees? American Economic Association Committee on the Status of LGBTQ+ Individuals in the Economics Profession (CSQIEP) Virtual Seminar Series, March 2026.
4. Speaker: How does Medicaid Coverage of Gender-affirming Care Impact Utilization and Adverse Mental Health Outcomes among Medicaid Enrollees? Boston Children's Hospital, March 2026, Boston, MA.
5. Moderator: Gray Babb's presentation on Drivers of Quality Differences between Transgender and Cisgender Medicare Beneficiaries. Harvard SOGIE Speaker Series. January, 2026, Boston, MA.
6. Speaker: How does Medicaid Coverage of Gender-affirming Care Impact Utilization and Adverse Mental Health Outcomes among Medicaid Enrollees? Boston Children's Hospital, March 2025, Boston, MA.
7. Speaker: Rates of Insurance Coverage of Gender-affirming Care and Utilization among Transgender Adults by Insurance Type in 2022, Boston Children's Hospital, March 2024, Boston, MA.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS, WHITE PAPERS, & COMMENTARIES

1. **Koma JW**, Cubanski J, Neuman T. FAQs on Medicare Coverage of Telehealth. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. May 2022.
2. **Koma JW**, Freed M, Cubanski J, Neuman T. Seven in Ten Medicare Beneficiaries Did Not Compare Plans During Past Open Enrollment Period. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. October 2021.
3. **Koma JW**, Cubanski J, Neuman T. Medicare and Telehealth: Coverage and Use During the COVID-19 Pandemic and Options for the Future. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. May 2021.

4. **Koma JW**, Cubanski J, Neuman T. A Snapshot of Sources of Coverage Among Medicare Beneficiaries in 2018. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. March 2021.
5. **Koma JW**, Fugelsten Biniek J, Ochieng N, Neuman T, Smith K. Does Education Narrow the Gap in Wealth Among Older Adults, by Race and Ethnicity? *Kaiser Family Foundation*. February 2021.
6. Freed M, **Koma JW**, Cubanski J, Fugelsten Biniek J, Neuman T. More Than Half of All People on Medicare Do Not Compare Their Coverage Options Annually. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. October 2020.
7. **Koma JW**, Rae M, Ramaswamy A, Neuman T, Kates J, Dawson L. Demographics, Insurance Coverage, and Access to Care Among Transgender Adults. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. October 2020.
8. **Koma JW**, True S, Fugelsten Biniek J, Cubanski J, Orgera K, Garfield R. One in Four Older Adults Report Anxiety or Depression Amid the COVID-19 Pandemic. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. October 2020.
9. Claxton G, Levitt L, Garfield R, Kamal R, Neuman T, Kates J, Michaud J, **Koma JW**, Rae M. How Many Teachers Are at Risk of Serious Illness If Infected with Coronavirus? *Kaiser Family Foundation*. July 2020.
10. True S, Ochieng N, Cubanski J, **Koma JW**, Neuman T. Under the Radar: States Vary in Regulating and Reporting COVID-19 in Assisted Living Facilities. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. June 2020.
11. Claxton G, Levitt L, Garfield R, Kamal R, Neuman T, Kates J, Michaud J, **Koma JW**, Rae M. Almost One in Four Adult Workers is Vulnerable to Severe Illness from COVID-19. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. June 2020.
12. **Koma JW**, Artiga S, Neuman T, Claxton G, Rae M, Kates J, Michaud J. Low-Income and Communities of Color at Higher Risk of Serious Illness if Infected with Coronavirus. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. May 2020.
13. Cubanski J, Neuman T, **Koma JW**. Older Adults Are Hit Hard by COVID-19 – and Also Losing Jobs. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. May 2020.
14. Neuman T and **Koma JW**. Retirement Insecurity in the Time of COVID-19: The Next Shoe to Drop? *Kaiser Family Foundation*. April 2020.
15. **Koma JW**, Neuman T, Jacobson G, Smith K. Medicare Beneficiaries' Financial Security Before the Coronavirus Pandemic. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. April 2020.
16. **Koma JW**, Neuman T, Claxton G, Rae M, Kates J, Michaud J. How Many Adults Are at Risk of Serious Illness If Infected with Coronavirus? Updated Data. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. April 2020.
17. Orgera K, McDermott D, Rae M, Claxton G, **Koma JW**, Cox C. Urban and Rural Differences in Coronavirus Pandemic Preparedness. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. April 2020.
18. Neuman T, **Koma JW**, Pollitz K, Tolbert J, True S. Where do the Democratic Candidates Stand on Health Reform and Prescription Drug Prices? *Kaiser Family Foundation*. February 2019.
19. **Koma JW**, Cubanski J, Jacobson G, Damico A, Neuman T. No Itch to Switch: Few Medicare Beneficiaries Switch Plans During the Open Enrollment Period. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. December 2019.
20. Neuman T, Pollitz K, Tolbert J, Rudowitz R, **Koma JW**. 10 Key Questions on

Public Option Proposals. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. December 2019.

21. Cubanski J, **Koma JW**, Damico A, Neuman T. How Much Do Medicare Beneficiaries Spend Out of Pocket on Health Care? *Kaiser Family Foundation*. November 2019.
22. Cubanski J, **Koma JW**, Neuman T. The Out-of-Pocket Cost Burden for Specialty Drugs in Medicare Part D in 2019. *Kaiser Family Foundation*. February 2019.
23. Cubanski J, **Koma JW**, Damico A, Neuman T. How Many Seniors Live in Poverty? *Kaiser Family Foundation*. November 2018.
24. **Koma JW**, Jarlenski M, Casnoff Austein C. Smoking in America: Medicaid, Quitting, and Income. *The Medical Care Blog*. November 2017.
25. **Koma JW** and Jarlenski M. The Political Context of Medicaid Expansion. *The Medical Care Blog*. March 2017.

LEADERSHIP & ACADEMIC SERVICE

AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting

- Abstract Reviewer, Women and Gender Health Interest Group, 2025 – Present

Harvard Medical School

- Small Group Substitute Discussion Leader, Essentials of the Profession, 2025

Harvard University Ph.D. Program in Health Policy

- Co-leader, Graduate Student Mental Health Survey Working Group, 2025
- Coordinator, Health Policy LGBTQ+ Student Group, 2023 – 2025

Harvard College Pforzheimer House

- Non-resident Tutor, 2023 – 2025

REFERENCES

Meredith Rosenthal
(Dissertation Committee Chair)
Department Chair and C. Boyden Gray Professor of Health Economics and Policy
Harvard T.H. Chan School of Public Health
mrosenth@hsph.harvard.edu

Nicole Maestas
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Haiden Huskamp
Henry J. Kaiser Professor of Health Care Policy
Harvard Medical School
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